

SC 2222&1
WASSCE 2026
GEOGRAPHY 2&1
Essay and Objective
3 hours

2&1

Name

Index Number

THE WEST AFRICAN EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL

**West African Senior School Certificate Examination
for School Candidates**

SC 2026

GEOGRAPHY 2&1
Essay and Objective

3 hours

Do not open this booklet until you are told to do so. While you are waiting, read and observe the following instructions carefully. Write your name and index number in ink in the spaces provided above.

This booklet consists of two papers. Answer Paper 2 which comes first, in your answer booklet and Paper 1 on your Objective Test answer sheet. Paper 2 will last 2 hours after which the answer booklet will be collected. Do not start Paper 1 until you are told to do so. Paper 1 will last 1 hour.

Answer four questions in all: three questions from Section A and one question from Section B.
All questions carry equal marks.

SECTION A
REGIONAL GEOGRAPHY OF GHANA

Answer three questions only from this section.

1. (a) Draw an outline map of Ghana. [1 mark]
On the map, locate and name:
(i) the Dry Equatorial climatic belt; [2 marks]
(ii) the Tropical Continental climatic belt; [2 marks]
(iii) one regional capital town in 1(a)(ii). [1 mark]
(b) Outline:
(i) four differences between the Dry Equatorial climate and the Tropical Continental climate in Ghana; [8 marks]
(ii) three similarities between the Dry Equatorial climate and the Tropical Continental climate in Ghana. [6 marks]
2. In a geography group assignment, you have been tasked to examine the factors which influence population distribution as well as environmental challenges caused by rapid population growth in Ghana.
(a) As the leader of your group, outline:
(i) three human factors which influence population distribution; [6 marks]
(ii) three physical factors which influence population distribution. [6 marks]
(b) Highlight four environmental challenges caused by rapid population growth in Ghana. [8 marks]
3. Ghana has traditionally relied on cocoa, gold and timber as its main export commodities for international trade. In recent years, the government has implemented policies to promote export of non-traditional commodities such as processed foods, horticultural products and handicrafts to the global market.
(a) Analyze five ways by which the diversification of export trade contribute to the socio-economic development of Ghana. [10 marks]
(b) Outline five challenges faced by the trade sector in Ghana. [10 marks]
4. You have been tasked to explain desert encroachment in Ghana to your colleagues who were absent during the lesson. Write your explanation under the following headings:
(a) definition of *desert encroachment*; [2 marks]
(b) three major causes; [6 marks]
(c) three effective control measures; [6 marks]
(d) three factors that may hinder the successful implementation of the control measures stated in 4(c). [6 marks]
5. (a) Identify five challenges caused by nucleated settlements in Ghana. [10 marks]
(b) Suggest five measures that can be adopted to maximize the benefits of nucleated settlements in Ghana. [10 marks]

3
SECTION B
REGIONAL GEOGRAPHY OF WEST AFRICA AND AFRICA

Answer one question only from this section.

6. Write a geographical account on the Savanna vegetation in Africa under the following headings:
- (a) four areas the vegetation can be found; [4 marks]
 - (b) four characteristics of the vegetation; [8 marks]
 - (c) four socio-economic benefits of the vegetation. [8 marks]
7. (a) Draw an outline map of Africa. [2 marks]
On the map, locate and name:
- (i) the longest river; [2 marks]
 - (ii) the largest natural lake; [2 marks]
 - (iii) one country through which the longest river flows. [2 marks]
- (b) In what four ways do rivers contribute to the socio-economic development of Africa? [8 marks]
- (c) Highlight two physical factors which hinder river transportation in Africa. [4 marks]
8. Write a geographical account of Africa under the following headings:
- (a) size; [3 marks]
 - (b) location and position; [5 marks]
 - (c) four characteristics of the relief of Africa; [4 marks]
 - (d) four significance of the relief of Africa. [8 marks]

END OF PAPER

BLANK SHEET

**DO NOT TURN OVER THIS PAGE
UNTIL YOU ARE TOLD TO DO SO.**

**YOU WILL BE PENALIZED SEVERELY IF YOU ARE
FOUND LOOKING AT THE NEXT PAGE BEFORE
YOU ARE TOLD TO DO SO.**

**WHILE YOU ARE WAITING, READ THE FOLLOWING
INSTRUCTIONS CAREFULLY**

PAPER 1
OBJECTIVE TEST
[50 marks]

1 hour

1. Use 2B pencil throughout.
2. On the pre-printed answer sheet, check that the following details are correctly printed:
 - (a) In the space marked Name, check your **surname** followed by your **other names**.
 - (b) In the spaces marked *Examination, Year, Subject* and *Paper*, check 'WASSCE (SC)', '2026', 'GEOGRAPHY', and '1' respectively.
 - (c) In the box marked Index Number, your index number has been printed vertically in the spaces on the left-hand side, and each numbered space has been shaded in line with each digit. **Reshade** each of the shaded spaces.
 - (d) In the box marked *Subject Code*, the digits 222113 are printed vertically in the spaces on the left-hand side. **Reshade** the corresponding numbered spaces as you did for your index number.
3. An example is given below. This is for a male candidate whose name is Tony Mensah ATIAH. His *index number* is 7102143958 and he is offering *Geography 1*.

**THE WEST AFRICAN EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL
ANSWER SHEET**

PRINT IN BLOCK LETTERS	
Name: ATIAH TONY MENSAH	GHA
Examination: WASSCE (SC)	Year: 2026
Subject: GEOGRAPHY	Paper: 1

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES

1. Use grade 2B pencil throughout.
2. Answer each question by choosing one letter and shading like this: **A** ☐ **B** ☐ **C** ☐ **D** ☐
3. Erase completely any answer you wish to change.
4. Leave extra spaces blank if the answer spaces provided are more than you need.
5. Do not make any markings across the heavy black marks at the right hand edge of your answer sheet.

INDEX NUMBER										SUBJECT CODE										
7	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	2	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
1	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	2	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
0	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	2	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
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5	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	3	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
8	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	3	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9

For Supervisors only

If candidate is absent shade this space

Answer all the questions.

Each question is followed by four options lettered A to D. Find the correct option for each question. Shade in pencil on your answer sheet, the answer space which bears the same letter as the option you have chosen.

Give only one answer to each question. An example is given below.

Which of the following is the most common form of migration in developing countries?

- A. Rural-rural
- B. Rural-urban
- C. Urban-rural
- D. Urban-urban

The correct answer is **rural-urban**, which is lettered **B**, and therefore answer space **B** would be shaded.

☐ A ☒ B ☐ C ☐ D

Think carefully before you shade the answer spaces; erase completely any answers you wish to change.

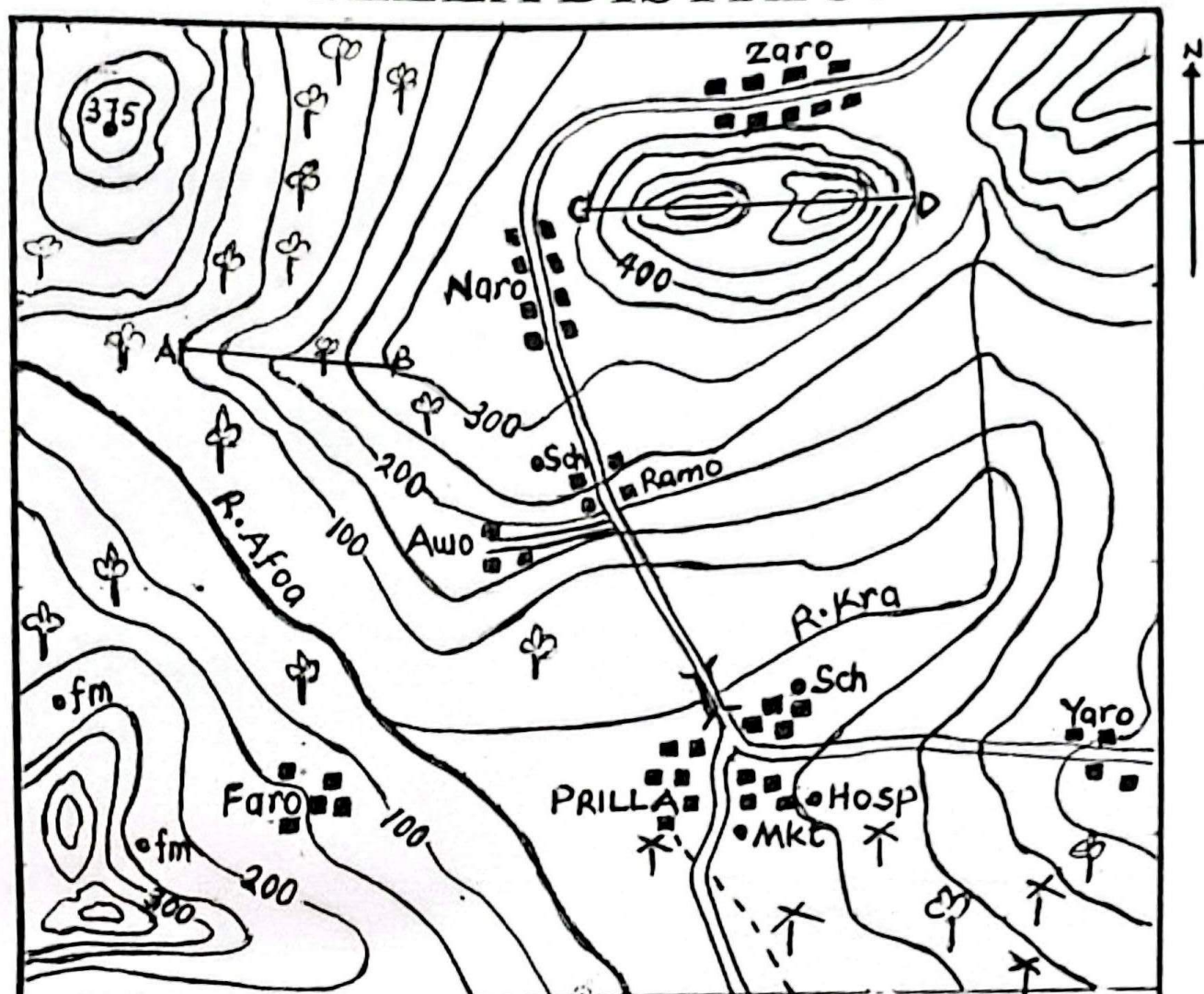
Do all rough work in this question paper.

Now answer the following questions.

Study the map of **PRILLA DISTRICT** and use it to answer questions 1 to 7.

1. You are given this topographical map with a Representative Fraction scale of 1 : 25,000. If you measure 1 centimetre between two points on the map, what would be the actual ground distance in kilometres between these points?
 - A. 4.0 kilometres
 - B. 2.5 kilometres
 - C. 1.8 kilometres
 - D. 0.25 kilometre
2. Based on the map's elevation and terrain data, which part of the mapped area would be least suitable for the installation of a telecommunication mast?
 - A. North eastern
 - B. North western
 - C. South eastern
 - D. South western
3. Which of the following factors will be evidence from the mapped area to prove that Zaro is not intervisible from PRILLA?
 - A. The dense oil palm plantation
 - B. The gentle sloping highland
 - C. The thick forest vegetation
 - D. The limited access to waterway
4. You are tasked to draw a cross profile along the line A - B. Using a vertical scale of 1 cm on the map to represent 50 metres on the ground, calculate the number of times the slopes will appear steeper on the cross profile compared to the actual appearance on the ground.
 - A. 2 times
 - B. 5 times
 - C. 10 times
 - D. 50 times
5. Which of the following landforms is likely to be identified on the mapped area when you draw a simple cross section along the line C - D.
 - A. Plateau
 - B. Ridge
 - C. Cuesta
 - D. Spur

PRILLA DISTRICT



1 : 25 000

	Contour in metres		Oil palm
	River		Bridge
	Settlement		School
	Road		Market
	Footpath		Hospital
	Forest		Farm

- 8
6. Based on the distribution of settlements and supporting map evidence, which of the following statements **best** explain why PRILLA settlement is **more** important than Yaro settlement? It
- A. covers a wider area than Yaro.
 - B. is closer to agricultural land than Yaro.
 - C. is located on lower elevation than Yaro.
 - D. performs more functions than Yaro.
7. Taking into account **both** natural resources and accessibility, which of the following economic activities is **most likely** to dominate in the north western part of the mapped area?
- A. Farming
 - B. Lumbering
 - C. Mining
 - D. Trading
8. Ghana Post wants to use a data type that uses specific locations represented by latitudes and longitudes in their operations. Which of the following types of data would the company consider?
- A. Point data
 - B. Raster data
 - C. Polygon data
 - D. Attribute data
9. An environmental geographer is studying changes in the coastal regions of Ghana. She compares images from several years to determine how much land has been lost to erosion. Which of the following data collection tools is she relying on for this analysis?
- A. Ground survey
 - B. GPS sensing
 - C. Remote sensing
 - D. Remote survey
10. A team of geographers is planning to map vegetation cover in mining areas in Ghana. Which of the following tools would be the **most** appropriate for collecting this data?
- A. GPS receiver
 - B. Satellite imagery
 - C. Tape measure
 - D. Topographical map
11. A health agency is tracking cholera outbreak using data on reported cases, water sources and population density. They must choose the best type of map for visualizing the spread. Why is a dot map with geospatial data more effective than other types in this case? It shows
- A. administrative boundaries.
 - B. exact case location and cluster of infections.
 - C. exact visual boundaries.
 - D. regional boundaries and cluster.
12. A forestry department in Ghana needs to create a detailed 3D map of the Kakum forest canopy to study tree heights, forest density, and under-storey vegetation. They are considering different remote sensing technologies. *LiDAR* technology has been recommended because it can penetrate through gaps in the forest canopy and measure multiple elevations at the same location. Which of the following technologies does *LiDAR* **primarily** use to collect this detailed geospatial data about the forest structure?
- A. High resolution cameras that photograph the forest from an aircraft
 - B. Laser pulses that are emitted towards the ground and timed as they reflect back from various surfaces
 - C. Radar waves that penetrate clouds and vegetation to image the ground
 - D. Global Positioning System that track the position of individual trees in the forest

13. A climatologist observes that isotherms are closely spaced on a weather map, which of the following can be inferred about temperature gradient in that area?
- The temperature is uniform throughout the region with no gradient present.
 - The temperature gradient cannot be determined from isotherm spacing alone.
 - The temperature gradient is gentle indicating slow temperature change over a long distance.
 - The temperature gradient is steep indicating rapid temperature change over a short distance.
14. A climatologist observes that, a given geographical area recorded an annual rainfall less than 250 mm and experience high rate of evaporation. Which climatic characteristic can **best** be deduced from the climatologist's observation?
- High humidity
 - Low humidity
 - Low diurnal range of temperature
 - High annual range of temperature
15. Which of the following **best** describes environmental lapse rate?
- The rate at which temperature decreases with altitude
 - The rate at which air pressure decreases with altitude
 - The rate at which temperature increases with altitude
 - The rate at which air pressure increases with altitude

16. Two cities A and B are **both** located on latitude 40° N. A geography student collects the following climate data for both cities.

Feature	City A	City B
Elevation	2500 metres above sea level	50 metres above sea level
Distance from ocean	800 kilometres inland	5 kilometres from the coast
Average July temperature	18 °C	28 °C
Average January temperature	-5 °C	8 °C
Annual range of temperature	23 °C	20 °C
Annual rainfall	400 mm	1100 mm

Based on the data provided, which of the following statements **best** explains why Cities A and B have such different climates despite being located on the same latitude?

- City A receives less solar radiation due to its higher elevation while City B's coastal location increases its exposure to sunlight throughout the year.
 - City A's high elevation results in cooler temperatures and less rainfall while City B's proximity to the ocean moderates its temperature and increases rainfall.
 - City A experiences continental climate due to its distance from the ocean while City B has more extreme temperature because of coastal wind pattern.
 - City A's inland location creates longer daylight hours in summer while City B's coastal position results in shorter days and milder temperatures.
17. The composition of the Earth's atmosphere changes with increasing altitude because
- gases remain the same proportion in all layers.
 - heavier gases become concentrated in all layers.
 - lighter gases become more concentrated at higher altitude.
 - gases become equally distributed at higher altitude.
18. A farmer observes that crops in one field are wilting faster than in another field despite equal watering. What soil property **most likely** explains this difference?
- Soil colour retention capacity
 - Soil aeration retention capacity
 - Soil temperature retention capacity
 - Soil moisture retention capacity

19. A community wants to prevent gully erosion. Which of the following methods of soil conservation would be the **most appropriate** to adopt?
- Crop rotation
 - Building check dams
 - Leaving the land bare
 - Burning crop remains
20. A rock in a hot, dry area experiences cracking and peeling-off of its outer layer due to contraction and expansion. Which of the following processes of weathering is exhibited by the rock?
- Chemical weathering through oxidation
 - Physical weathering through exfoliation
 - Biological weathering through root penetration
 - Chemical weathering through hydrolysis
21. A geologist examines two rock samples A and B. Rock A contains visible crystals of different sizes with no layers or fossils. Rock B has distinct layers and contains shell fossils. Based on these observations, which types of rock samples did the geologist examine?
- Rock A is sedimentary and Rock B is igneous
 - Rock A is igneous and Rock B is sedimentary
 - Rock A is metamorphic and Rock B is igneous
 - Rock A is sedimentary and Rock B is metamorphic
22. A student finds a rock with bands of different coloured minerals that appear wavy and folded. The minerals are aligned in parallel layers and the rock is very hard. The student also notices some crystals have been flattened. Which of the following processes **best** explains how this rock is formed?
- Cooling and crystallization of molten magma lava at the surface of the Earth
 - Compaction and cementation of sediments in layers over time
 - Extreme heat and pressure altering existing rock without melting it
 - Rapid cooling of magma forming glassy texture with no crystals
23. Geography helps us to understand our world through the relationship between
- people and environment.
 - people in different places.
 - environment and culture.
 - people and diseases.
24. A geography class is learning about the structure of the Earth. One student asked: *How do scientists know the outer core is liquid if no one has ever been there or seen it?* Which of the following evidences **best** answers the question asked by the students?
- Volcanic lava comes from deep inside the Earth and is liquid when it erupts.
 - S-waves from earthquakes cannot travel through the outer core, showing it must be liquid.
 - Computer calculations show that the outer core's temperature would melt iron.
 - The deep drilling projects have found liquid metals below the crust.
25. A city located at latitude 45° N receives more insolation in June than in December. Which of the following **best** explains this seasonal difference?
- The Earth moves closer to the Sun in June.
 - The cloud cover increases for long hours in December.
 - The moon blocks solar radiation in December.
 - The Sun's rays strike more directly for long hours in June.
26. A river in its middle course has well developed meander. On the outside of each bend, the river bank is steep and actively eroding while on the inside of each bend, a gently sloping deposit of sand and gravels has formed. What combination of processes **best** explains this pattern?
- Fast flow erodes the outer bank while slow flow deposits on the inner bank.
 - Hydraulic action undercuts the outer bank while traction deposits materials on the inner bank.
 - Abrasion wears away the outer bank while saltation builds up the inner bank.
 - Greater water depth on the outer bank increases erosion while shallow water promotes deposition.

27. Which of the following landforms is created when a river flows over a cliff?
- Delta
 - Flood plain
 - Meander
 - Waterfall
28. A farmer notices two flat plains in different regions have very different crop yields. Plain A which is an erosional plain produces poor harvest despite the use of fertilizer while Plain B which is a depositional plain produces excellent crops with minimal use of fertilizer. Which of the following **best** explains why depositional plains are generally more fertile than erosional plains?
- Depositional plains receive more rainfall than erosional plains
 - Depositional plains gain nutrient-rich top soil while erosional plains lose it
 - Depositional plains are located in warmer climates than erosional plains
 - Depositional plains have flatter surfaces that improve water distribution
29. A pilot flies from City A located on latitude 20° S to City B which is located on latitude 10° N. Calculate the distance in kilometres covered by the pilot.
- 4,440 km
 - 3,330 km
 - 2,220 km
 - 1,110 km
30. Ox-bow lakes are formed as a result of
- a main river capturing a tributary river to divert its flow into the main river.
 - flooding creating a new river channel.
 - depositing sediments at river delta.
 - the cut-off of a meander loop due to erosion and deposition.
31. Which of the following factors is the defining ecological characteristic that explains why mangroves thrive along coastal lagoons rather than inland fresh water areas in Ghana?
- High annual rainfall
 - Saline water conditions
 - Prevalence of strong winds
 - Presence of sandy soil
32. Country X has a total land area of $50,000 \text{ km}^2$ and a population density of 3 persons per square kilometres. A development agency is planning to deliver health care services to the population. What does the population density imply for healthcare delivery in Country X?
- Healthcare facilities will need to serve large geographical area with few people, making service delivery challenging and expensive.
 - Health care facilities can be concentrated in small areas because the population is densely clustered together.
 - The low population density means there is no need for health care infrastructure in the country.
 - Each health care facility only needs to serve 3 patients, making service delivery simple and cost-effective.
33. In certain areas in Ghana, vegetation is sparse despite moderate rainfall distribution. Which of the following **pairs** of physical factors could account for this?
- Poor soil fertility
 - Steep slope
 - Low sun intensity
 - Waterlogged soils
- I, II and IV only
 - II, III and IV only
 - I, III and IV only
 - I, II and III only

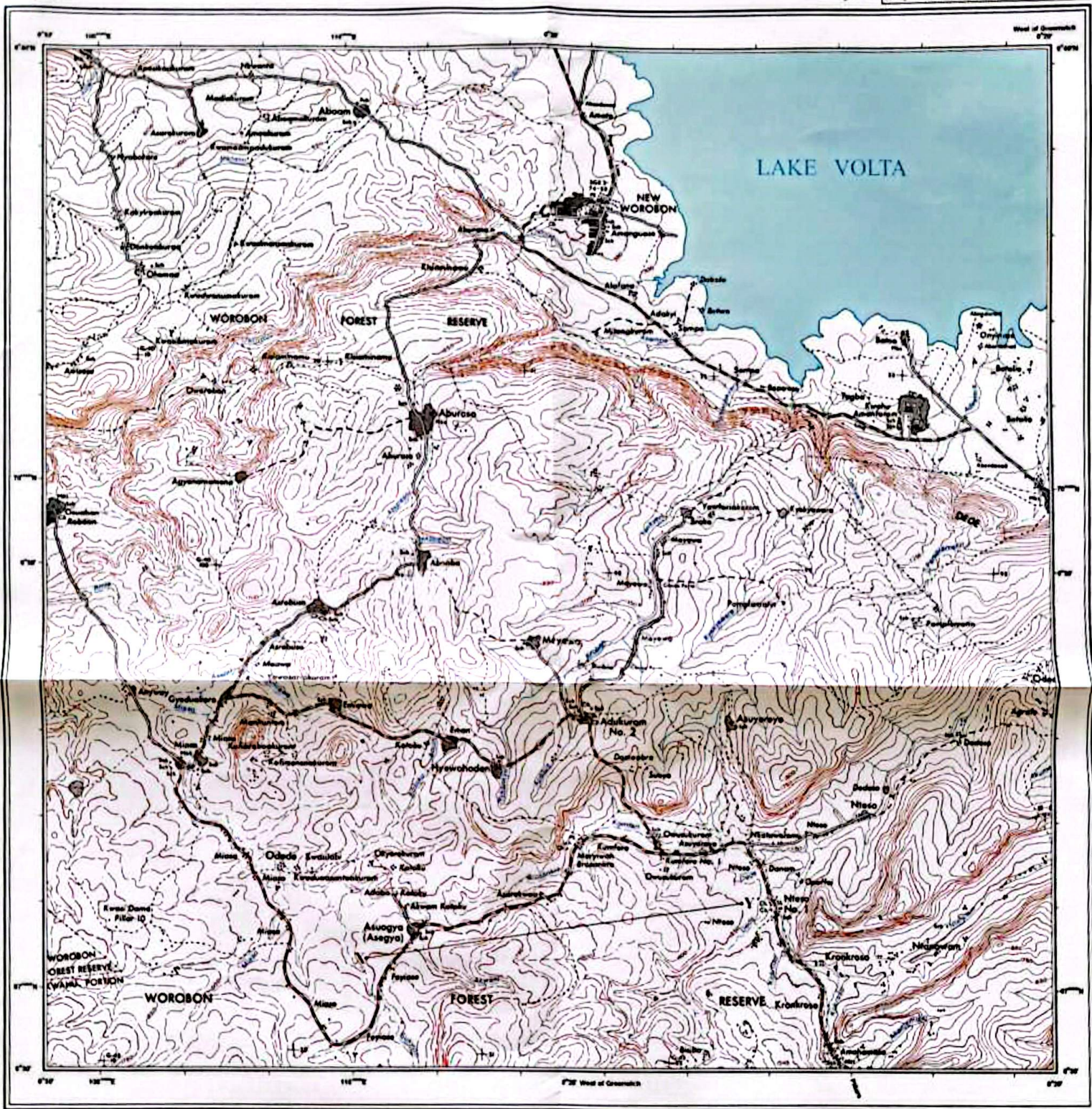
34. The population in Accra has surged in recent years due to rural-urban migration. The city now faces frequent power outages and water shortages. What is the **most likely** reason for these challenges?
- Over use of urban infrastructure
 - Over use of imported commodities in urban cities
 - Poor government policy on decentralization
 - Poor implementation of decentralization policies
35. In comparing nucleated and linear settlements patterns found in Southern Ghana, which of the following factors **most likely** explains the difference in their spatial arrangements?
- Availability of internet services
 - Historical trade routes in Southern Ghana
 - Location of water bodies and routes
 - Religious beliefs of the settlers
36. Which of the following types of plains is **most likely** to be formed from river deposition?
- Alluvial plain
 - Erosional plain
 - Tidal plain
 - Volcanic plain
37. A region has a population density of 5 persons per square kilometre. What does this information indicate about the region?
- The region is sparsely populated with an average of 5 people living in each square kilometre area.
 - The region has exactly 5 people living in the centre of each square kilometre.
 - The total population of the region is 5 people spread across multiple square kilometres.
 - Each person in the region occupies exactly 5 square kilometres of the land space.
38. River ports in Ghana particularly those along Volta Lake face challenges including seasonal water level fluctuations, siltation of harbours, poor infrastructure, and competition from road transportation. A government committee must prioritize two measures to improve the viability of these river ports. Which of the following interventions would address these critical challenges?
- Building higher dock structures to accommodate water level changes and reducing road transportation options to increase river traffic
 - Regular dredging operations to maintain navigation depth and construction of modern warehouse and cargo handling facilities
 - Introduction of larger vessels that can carry more cargo and increasing passenger fares to generate more revenue.
 - Relocating ports away from silted areas and banning fishing activities near port zones
39. The Kakum National Park is a popular tourist attraction destination in Southern Ghana **mainly** because of its
- canopy walkway and wildlife.
 - canopy walkway and underground caves.
 - canopy walkway and castle.
 - canopy walkway and big elephants.
40. The **primary** goal of establishing import substitution industries in Ghana is to
- ban all import activities.
 - increase import of foreign goods.
 - produce goods locally.
 - replace local goods with imported ones.
41. Which of the following challenges is **most likely** to discourage foreign investors from trading with Ghana?
- Cheap and affordable labour
 - High level of local production
 - High tariffs on imported goods
 - Stable exchange rate

42. A manufacturing company in Southern Ghana wants to transport finished goods to Northern markets using water transportation. Which of the following ports should the company consider as the final destination?
- Akosombo port
 - Tema port
 - Buipe port
 - Yeji port
43. The **most** effective way to reduce water pollution in river bodies in Ghana is by
- constructing more dams to control water flow and dilute pollutants.
 - enforcing regulations against illegal mining and establishing riparian buffer zones.
 - treating industrial and domestic waste water before discharge into rivers.
 - educating communities on proper waste disposal and reducing plastic pollution.
44. A farmer in Eastern Region observes severe soil erosion on his cocoa farm while his neighbour's farm with similar slope shows minimal land degradation. Which combination of factors **best** explain this difference?
- Slope angle and rainfall intensity
 - Farming practices and vegetation cover
 - Soil type and elevation
 - Temperature and wind pattern
45. Which of the following is a **major** air pollutant in Ghana?
- Sulphur dioxide from coal-fired power stations
 - Particulate matter from vehicles emission
 - Chloroflourocarbons from refrigeration manufacturing plants
 - Ammonia from large scale livestock operation
46. A visit to the Ghana Meteorological Agency gave the opportunity to access data which shows that there are increased occurrences of floods and droughts. Which of the following phenomena does this trend **strongly** support?
- Climate change
 - Random weather fluctuations
 - Poor temperature inversion
 - Environmental lapse rate
47. Two neighbouring communities in Northern Ghana experience different frequencies of bush fires despite having similar vegetation and climate. Community A has frequent destructive fires while Community B rarely experience uncontrolled fires. Which of the following factors **most** likely accounts for this difference?
- Community A practises late season burning while Community B burns early in the dry season
 - Community A has sandy soils that dry faster than Community B's clay soil
 - Community A experiences stronger harmattan winds than Community B
 - Community A has more grassland while Community B has more scrubland
48. Which of the following measures should be the **highest** priority when developing community flood preparedness plan for a rural community during the rainy season?
- Constructing flood barriers around district capitals
 - Identifying safe evacuation routes and establishing early warning systems
 - Building drainage system exclusively in urban centres
 - Training only National Disaster Management Organization officials in flood response

Turn over

49. Which of the following examples **best** illustrates the transition from a hazard to a disaster?
- A. A category 3 hurricane making landfill in an evacuated coastal area without casualties
 - B. A drought lasting six months in an agricultural region, destroying crops and forcing mass migration
 - C. A rockfall occurring on a remote mountain face with no witness
 - D. A blizzard dumping three feet of snow in an unpopulated Arctic region
50. Which of the following reasons explains why communities facing desert encroachment often experience food shortage?
- A. Drought causes waterlogged soils
 - B. Reduced soil fertility
 - C. Increased soil fertility
 - D. Dry soil increases plant growth

END OF PAPER



SCALE: 1:50,000

